

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} North Korea announced a detailed plan to launch a volley of ballistic missiles toward the U.S. Pacific territory of Guam, a major military hub and home to U.S. bombers, and dismissed President Donald Trump's threats of "fire and fury" if it doesn't back down.
- ^{2.} It is unclear whether North Korea would risk firing missiles so close to U.S. territory, which could provoke countermeasures and further escalation.
- ^{3.} The Hweasong-12, which was revealed for the first time at a military parade in April, is an intermediate-range ballistic missile that is believed to have a range of more than 3,700 kilometers.
- ^{4.} It said the plan could be finalized within a week or so and would then go to leader Kim Jong Un for approval.
- ^{5.} It would be up to Mr. Kim whether the move is actually carried out and the missiles would hit waters 30 to 40 kilometers away from the island.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the missile power of North Korea and how this country has been going about its missile build-up. The starter would be choice 1 which talks about the announcement of North Korea to launch a volley of ballistic missiles on a major US military hub. Choice 4 follows, talking about finalizing this plan with the approval of its leader Kim Jong Un. Choice 5 comes next saying that, carrying out the move will solely depend on Kim Jong Un's decision. Choice 2 summarizes saying whether North Korea would risk going ahead with such a plan and invite the antagonism of the US of America. Thus 1, 4, 5, 2 is the logical sequence of the sentences and choice 3 talking about a particular missile may be later in the passage.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. Agatha Christie lived here once, but only memories remain of the time the best-selling crime writer spent among the ruins of the ancient Iraqi city of Nimrud.
2. The mound on which the ruins are situated has a fresh crown of razor wire to keep looters out, and until recently, corpses floated down the river Tigris from battlefields upstream.
3. Islamic State attacked Nimrud with bulldozers, jackhammers and dynamite three years ago as part of their general assault on Iraq's cultural heritage.
4. If she were alive today, she would probably be shocked by what has befallen the Assyrian city where she worked alongside her archaeologist husband five decades ago.
5. The mud-brick house where the British author of *Murder on the Orient Express* once stayed is long gone.

Solution:

The paragraph is about Nimrud, where Agatha Christie, the best-selling crime writer had spent her life. The starter would be choice 1 talking about Nimrud and Agatha Christie and how, today, only her memories remain in this ancient Iraqi city. Choice 5 is next saying that the mud-brick house of the author has vanished. Choice 4 is next lamenting that had she been alive today she would have been shocked by what had befallen this city. Choice 3 sums up stating how the Islamic State attacked Nimrud with bulldozers and dynamite as part of their general attack on Iraq. Thus 1, 5, 4, 3 is the logical sequence of the sentences while choice 2 which talks about razor wires and corpses floating in the Tigris, may be later in the passage.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. The Attari-Wagah border is a popular tourist site as thousands of people gather here every evening to witness the ceremony where the flags of both the nations are lowered.
2. Reports also suggest that the tower on which the flag would be hoisted has been equipped with high-resolution cameras which can spy into the Indian territory.
3. Reportedly, the flag is fifty feet higher than India's tallest tri-colour.
4. Meanwhile, Indian citizens are sceptical about this move of Pakistan as they believe it might pose a security threat to the nation.
5. Pakistan is all set to hoist the tallest flag in its territory at the Wagah-Attari border on 14th August - its Independence Day.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the tallest flag which Pakistan is set to hoist on its independence day on 14th August. The starter would be choice 5 which talks about this flag. Choice 3 is next reporting that this flag is fifty feet taller than the highest tri-color. Choice 2 comes next with the anxiety that this flag may be equipped with high-resolution cameras which can spy into the Indian territory. Choice 4 sums up, mentioning the apprehension of the citizens who are wary of a threat to national security. Thus 5324 is the logical order of the sentences and choice 1 talking about the tourist aspect of the Attari-Wagah border is the odd one out. Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. Much has changed today in Yadong, a town encompassed by picturesque mountains and bisected by a fast-flowing stream.
2. A small motorable bridge links the two flanks of the town.
3. Yadong also has an impressive hilltop hotel for the traveling elite, accessed by a road which passes through a busy market. Indian goods, from Maggi noodles and Parle biscuits to cosmetics, are available here.
4. Not long before the Doklam stand-off, deepening economic engagement between Tibet and Sikkim had become part of the official imagination.
5. This is the result of modest cross-border trade between Sikkim and Tibet that resumed in 2006 through Nathu La.

Solution:

The paragraph is about a small town named Yadong somewhere between Sikkim and Tibet. The starter would be choice 1 which states that much has changed in the town of Yadong with picturesque mountains and flowing streams. Choice 2 is next talking about a small motorable bridge linking both ends of the town. Choice 3 follows, talking about the impressive hilltop hotel for tourists with a busy market selling Indian goods from Maggie noodles to Parle biscuits. Choice 5 sums up talking about the reason for the availability of such goods. 1235 is the logical sequence of the sentences while choice 4, which talks about the Doklam standoff, may be later in the passage.

Ans : (4)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. Parents seem to have lost control over their children.
2. I stealthily glanced at the boy and found him looking into the blankness before him, layers of indifference and scorn on his face.
3. The number of dysfunctional families is growing and society is paying the price in terms of rising delinquencies by juveniles - thefts, rapes, individual and gang violence, cyber-crimes, drugs, suicides *et al*, a wanton waste of precious talent, potential and life.
4. Parenting skills that are so important in today's world, are not taught and this includes love, care, support, encouragement, praise, discipline, guidance and much, much more.
5. Most often, they themselves are embroiled in their own problems - marital emotional, physical, career-based, financial and so on.

Solution:

The paragraph is about lack of parenting skills and how it is resulting in lack of control over children. The starter would be choice 1 lamenting that parents have lost control over children. Choice 5 is next stating the reason for this loss of control. Choice 4 follows with how parenting skills are important to teach love, care, support guidance etc., Choice 3 sums up mentioning about the growing number of dysfunctional families and how this is taking a toll on the society. 1, 5, 4, 3 is the right sequence of sentences and choice 2 talking about a particular incident may be later in the passage.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. The soaps have taken gender empowerment and equality to unseen heights.
2. Some female plotters even knife their opponents to death and boast about their ghastly deeds without any pangs of remorse.
3. They hire goons to attack, maim and kill their perceived enemies at the drop of a hat.
4. Welcome the new tribe of lady villains who are as scheming and ruthless as their male counterparts.
5. It appears that the male monopolization of villainy has upset serial producers.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the increase in female villains in Television soaps. The humorous starter would be (1), which talks about gender empowerment scaling new heights. (5) follows saying that the 'all male villainy bastion' has upset the soap producers. (4) comes next welcoming the new tribe of lady villains. (3) is next talking about the activities of these lady villains. (2) sums up with how these women don't hesitate to kill their opponents and worse, even boast about their ghastly acts.

Ans : (15432)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Curious about his life, one fine day during my visit to the United Kingdom, I made my way to Stratford-upon-Avon, where the bard was born.
2. Ever since he found fame, Shakespeare's personal life has been under the microscope.
3. On my agenda was a small village known as Shottery, where Anne Hathaway, the bard's wife, lived before her marriage.
4. Ambling through green meadows, ancient houses wreathed in roses, I picked my way to Anne Hathaway's Cottage, which is a part of the Shakespeare Birthplace Trust.
5. It is a small and idyllic village, and retains its medieval charm.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the personal life of Shakespeare. (2) starts, talking about how Shakespeare's personal life has been under the scanner ever since he became famous. (1) follows with the author visiting the birth place of the bard. (3) is next talking about Shottery, where Shakespeare's wife lived before their marriage. (5) follows talking about this charming village. (4) sums up with the author describing the scene way to Hathaway cottage.

Ans : (21354)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} In the meantime, the descendants of the Hathaway family continued to live in the cottage until in 1846, when financial problems forced them to sell the property but, continued to live in the cottage as tenants.
- ^{2.} Not content with a visit to Shakespeare's house, visitors made a beeline to Anne Hathaway's childhood home.
- ^{3.} Soon, people began flocking to Stratford-upon-Avon, keen on seeing the house where he lived.
- ^{4.} With his popularity came the curiosity about Shakespeare's life and wife.
- ^{5.} By the late 18th century, several of Shakespeare's plays were published and became popular.

Solution:

(5) will be the ideal starter talking about how Shakespeare became popular by the late 18th century when his plays were published. (4) is next talking about the public curiosity of his life and his wife. (3) follows with how people started flocking to Stratford-upon-Avon to have a glimpse of the house where he lived. (2) is next mentioning the visitors also visiting Hathaway house. (1) sums up talking about the descendants of the Hathaway family.

Ans : (54321)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Spotting them amidst all the green was a favorite pastime.
2. The bulbuls were a familiar sight and almost always in a pair, they flew around shrubs and trees around the house.
3. Slowly they even started flying in and out of the compound, and we would hear their loud whistles.
4. We wondered whether it was favoring the plant for the insects but when we saw some straw and twigs on the plant, we realized that the bird was building a nest.
5. Recently, when the fir plant in front of the kitchen window became the bird's resting spot, my joy knew no bounds and I could see the red underbelly and the crown with great clarity.

Solution:

The paragraph is about a pair of bulbuls and the author's fascination for them. (2) is the starter talking about the familiar sight of the bulbuls. (1) is next talking about the favorite pastime of spotting them amidst the greenery. (3) follows describing how the birds started becoming familiar with the environment and their loud whistles. (5) is next, mentioning how the fir tree in front of the kitchen window became their resting spot. (4) sums up with the bulbul building a nest on the fir tree. Ans : (21354)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} An oft-quoted story is that of Monet having engaged a gardener just to meticulously clean the soot from the water lilies, as he wanted his lilies to look pristine always.
- ^{2.} The garden was designed for a specific way of seeing and a specific way of painting.
- ^{3.} In all, eight gardeners cared and nurtured the place, with Monet spending a good part of the day with them.
- ^{4.} The gardener would, first thing in the morning, take a boat and go round cleaning all the leaves and flowers in the pond.
- ^{5.} It was Monet's second artistic medium and here, a number of impressionist greats like Rodin, Cezanne, Mirabeau, Clemenceau and Monet met up.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the painter Claude Monet. The starter would be (1) talking about an oft-told story about the painter. (4) is next stating how the gardener would take a boat to clean all the leaves and flowers in the pond. (3) follows saying that there were eight gardeners to nurture the garden with Monet spending a good part of the day with them. (2) is next describing how the garden was designed for a specific way of seeing and painting. (5) sums up with how Monet met up with many famous painters of his era.

Ans : (14325)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

The Indian IT services sector may be passing through some rough weather with challenges of automation and lower growth rates, forcing many to lay off employees and reduce the rate of hiring. But many technology MNCs in the country are continuing to hire in large numbers. Companies such as Accenture, Capgemini, Oracle, IBM, and Goldman Sachs are hiring in hundreds, some in thousands.

1. Contrary to the trend of the Indian IT services sector shedding flab and curbing hiring due to automation and lower growth, many techno bigwigs like Accenture, Capgemini, Oracle, IBM and Goldman Sachs are on a hiring spree.
2. Challenges of automation and lower growth have forced Indian IT sector to lay off employees and reduce hiring but many technology MNCs are hiring in thousands.
3. Huge technology MNCs like Accenture, Capgemini, Oracle, IBM and Goldman Sachs are not affected by automation and lower growth rate and continue to hire in thousands.
4. The hiring spree by techno giants like Accenture, Capgemini, Oracle, IBM and Goldman Sachs has given new hope to IT professionals who have been laid off by their companies due to automation and lower growth rates.

Solution:

The key points here are:

(a) Indian IT services laying off employees and reduction in hiring rate.

(b) Many IT honchos continuing hiring in thousands.

Choice 2 misses out on the vital aspect of naming the hiring MNCs. Choices 3 and 4 convey a totally different meaning from that of the paragraph. Choice 1 contains the key points and succinctly captures the paragraph.

Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Sri Lanka's parliament has taken the rare step of accepting a huge donation of equipment including computers from a Chinese state-run company, China National Corporation For Overseas Economic Cooperation. The donation was received by the Sri Lankan Parliament Speaker from the Chinese ambassador in Colombo.

1. China had asked its ambassador in Colombo to donate equipment and computers to the Sri Lankan parliament from the State run company China National Corporation for Overseas Economic Corporation.
2. Chinese state-run company, China National Corporation for Overseas Economic Corporation has taken the rare step of donating computers and equipment to the Sri Lankan Parliament through the Chinese ambassador in Colombo.
3. In an unprecedented act, the Sri Lankan Parliament represented by its Speaker has accepted a huge donation of computers and equipment from the Chinese company, China National Corporation for Overseas Economic Corporation through the Chinese ambassador in Colombo.
4. As decided by the Chinese ambassador and the Speaker of the Sri Lankan Parliament, the Chinese company China National Corporation for Overseas Economic Corporation has arranged to donate equipment and computers to the Sri Lankan Parliament.

Solution:

The key points to note are:

(a) Rare step of accepting donation by Sri Lankan Parliament.

(b) Who is giving it?

(c) Who represents Sri Lanka and China

Choice 1 states that China had asked its ambassador to donate equipment to Sri Lanka which is not true. Choice 2 says that the Chinese company has taken the rare step to donate equipment which may or may not be true. Choice 4 puts more emphasis on the Speaker of the Sri Lankan Parliament and the Chinese ambassador instead of the rare act of accepting the donation by the Sri Lankan Parliament. Choice 3 covers all the relevant points and is the right answer.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

A teddy bear hospital has been launched in the UAE where children can check-in with their 'sick' teddies, the first of its kind facility in the UAE to help minors overcome anxiety while seeing a doctor. In the opening session, teddy bears underwent a 'CT scan', and were led into the surgery ward to get anesthetics before their operation.

1. In a novel attempt to make children comfortable while seeing a doctor, UAE has launched a teddy bear hospital where children can experience first hand, the facilities like CT scan and anesthetics when they take their 'sick' teddy bears for treatment.
2. In an attempt to help children overcome their fear of seeing a doctor, UAE has opened the first teddy bear hospital where children can take their 'sick' teddy bears for treatment and in the opening session the teddy bears were given a 'CT scan' and taken to the surgery ward for anesthesia.
3. To get children familiar with a hospital, UAE has started a teddy bear hospital where children can go to get their 'sick' teddy bears treated with *CT scan and surgeries*.
4. Attempting something different, UAE has launched its first teddy bear hospital to enable children with 'sick' teddy bears to get treatment like CT scan and surgeries for them.

Solution:

The key points are:

(a) Fear children have while seeing a doctor.

(b) The teddy bear hospital is the first of its kind.

(c) The facilities in the hospital.

Choice 3 misses out on the key point b). Choice 4 misses out on key point a). Choices 1 and 2 cover all the points but choice 2 is more elaborate while 1 is concise making it the right answer.

Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

When organoids, the simplified and miniaturised version of an organ found in our bodies, were cultured in Petri dishes some five years ago, it was considered among the biggest scientific advancements in recent times. For it opened up possibilities of studying how organs develop in your body, why they fail and how can they be revived. Using a patient's stem cells, cutting edge research is now being done to understand the most complex organ a human possesses - the brain. It is a brainy idea: develop these cells into mini-brains and understand what makes them tick, why they fail and test various forms of treatment to get them to work again. To do this, scientists are developing cerebral organoids from stem cells that have the features of a human brain similar to what a developing embryo has in the womb. _____

☒ a) Pharmaceutical companies are now exploring tie-ups with leading academic researchers to investigate even complex brain disorders. (Your answer - ✕)

- ☐ b) Doctors will be equipped with more tools to treat neurological disorders than what they currently have.
- ☐ c) Brain organoids are being used to understand the intricate and extensive neural network of human brain cells.
- ☐ d) Some of the neurological disorders that afflict humans are very difficult to cure.

Solution:

Mini brains developed from stem cells in a lab are now at an advanced level. Researchers are studying many neurological disorders, such as epilepsy and autism, on these brains. The sentence preceding the blank states that scientists are developing cerebral *organoids* from stem cells. Option (C) is an elaboration of the work being done by the scientists, and is apt for the blank. Option A appears disconnected. Option (B) says that doctors will be equipped with more tools to treat neurological disorders. How will they acquire more tools – is not known. Option (D) is a digressive. Choice (C)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

As a generalist standing at the threshold of your career, are you worried that while the world is talking about specialisations in fields like data science, machine learning and analytics, you don't stand a chance? Well, this may come as a surprise, but hiring experts say a large number of companies today are actually looking for generalists at entry levels. A generalist is a person who has the aptitude and skills which can be applied in a variety of different fields whereas a specialist is one who takes up a certain subject matter of a larger field and gains expertise in the same. Generalists, at some point, can become specialists by upgrading their skills and rise up the hierarchy. _____

- ☐ a) With mis-hiring costs rising to anywhere between 5-7 times annual salary, companies do not want to take that chance by hiring a wrong person.
- ☐ b) While earlier, at the time of hiring one would lay emphasis on specific qualifications at the time of hiring, employers are now focusing more on cognitive abilities than on specialisation.
- ☒ c) But companies are keen to bring on board generalists who can be moulded into specialists. (Your answer - )
- ☐ d) Some experts, however, believe while generalists may have a wider array of jobs to choose from, these at times can be loosely defined roles

Solution:

A generalist has the aptitude and skills which can be applied in a variety of different fields, while a specialist gains expertise in a subject of a larger field. Generalists can become specialists by upgrading their skills, and rise up the hierarchy. Option (C) is directly linked to the preceding sentence, which states that generalists, at some point of time, can become specialists by upgrading their skills. However, nowadays companies are keen on recruiting generalists who can be moulded into specialists. Thus, option (C) appropriately fits the blank. Option (A) says about the losses incurred by hiring the wrong persons, which is a different aspect. Option (B) is inapt because it makes no comparison between generalists and specialists. Option (D) is vague.

Choice (C)